

Beacon Group's Strategic Play: Reinventing Annuity based Financial Services from the Ground Up

In an industry traditionally dominated by decades-old institutions, the relatively young Beacon Group has emerged as a classic David challenging Goliaths. Founded in 2015 by ex-banker Pratapsingh Nathani, Beacon's SEBI-registered trustee arm now cumulatively administers close to ₹16 lakh crore (roughly US\$ 200 Billion) of corporate assets across more than 3,500 transactions – placing it shoulder-to-shoulder with firms 20–25 years its senior. In an age of new tech based disruption, Nathani picked up a slow moving boring process and has been disrupting and swallowing up marketshare of 20%. Even industry league tables recognize Beacon's rapid climb: it consistently ranks among the top three trustee firms in India (in fact, independent league tables like PRIME Database & India League Tables have placed it at No.2 nationwide for FY2024-25 for Bonds), a remarkable achievement for so young a company. While Nathani led from the front, Beacon's journey has also been shaped by other senior professionals from the industry. Interestingly, some of these early team members encashed their holdings and moved on before the IPO, unable to fully align with the long-term vision for what trusteeship in India could become. Yet, what Beacon has built since is a quiet testament to focus, foresight, and belief in a space that many had overlooked.

The Group's rise has been powered by a distinct approach. Rather than chasing quick-turnaround fees, Beacon focuses on stable, annuity-like revenues and uncompromising compliance. Instead of buying software for various functionalities, from day one it built its own technology backbone through its associate company Codium Techlabs to become India's first fully tech-enabled trustee platform – complete with a proprietary client-facing ERP system and specialized modules for securitization and covenant monitoring. This tech-centric DNA is championed by Executive Director Kaustubh Kulkarni,



Pratapsingh Nathani, the firm's Chairman and Managing Director

who has embedded AI analytics and even blockchain protocols into Beacon's processes. Kulkarni notes: **"We're not just adopting tech; we're architecting around it," adding that "the goal isn't efficiency alone—it's to make financial services intelligent, predictive, and fundamentally more secure."**

Beacon is already extending this digital ethos beyond trusteeship. Its Beacon Investor Holdings subsidiary has launched a "digital-first" Registrar & Transfer Agency platform, explicitly built for modern bond issuers, AIFs and forthcoming IPOs. As Kulkarni observes, Beacon is bringing "much-needed innovation to a traditionally legacy-driven" investor-servicing sector, combining stringent compliance with user-friendly tech.

DIVERSIFIED FINANCIAL SERVICES PLATFORM

Beacon Group has rapidly transformed into a one-stop financial-services platform. In addition to core

trusteeship work (serving as debenture trustee, security trustee, AIF trustee, ESOP trustee, etc.), the group now spans multiple adjacent verticals:

- **Fund Accounting & Compliance:** back-office services for mutual funds, AIFs, and other asset managers through Kratos Capital Advisors, an associate company.
- **Registrar & Transfer Agency (RTA):** via its wholly owned subsidiary, Beacon Investor Holdings
- **Wealth & Estate Planning and Payroll:** financial planning and payroll services for HNIs and corporations.
- **Digital Lending / Loan Aggregation:** an online platform for mortgage and loan products, called LoanXpress
- **Payroll Management via Beacon Payroll & Benefits**

GLOBAL GROWTH AND EXPANSION PLANS

Beacon is now aiming far beyond India's borders into Mauritius, Singapore and UAE. Its IPO filings outline plans to invest heavily in technology and to "expand service operations both domestically and internationally," including RTA and obtaining licenses for Depository Participant and RTA services. This push signals a focus on cross-border capital flows and offshore issuers, leveraging Beacon's tech stack for global markets.

FUTURE OUTLOOK

Leadership stresses that the IPO is only a springboard, not an endpoint. Chairman & MD, Mr Pratapsingh Nathani, a BFSI veteran, emphasizes that, **"The listing was undertaken to help reshape the industry and fuel further innovation. With capital in hand, Beacon plans to double down on its tech-driven model and expand its product suite globally."** Already, its league-table standings and deal volumes show this David has matched many Goliath rivals. If Beacon maintains this pace, its ascent may well redefine what is possible in India's trustee industry.